

Linked-up world

No living thing can manage on its own: all plants and animals rely on other life to survive. Each animal needs to find food—whether that is leaves, meat, or even dung. Each plant can grow properly only when nutrients from other organisms enrich the ground around its roots. Plants and animals are linked together in food chains that pass precious energy from one living thing to another.

Food web

The connections between living things are complicated. Many animals eat more than one kind of food. We call the links between the various plants and animals a food web.

Plants are green because they contain chlorophyll, which absorbs the sun's energy.



Many insects, such as locusts, feed on grass and other plants. They have mouthparts that can slice up vegetation.



Food chain

Plants take in the energy from sunlight and change it into food so that they grow. Herbivores (plant eaters) eat the plants, then carnivores (meat eaters) eat the herbivores. This series of connections is called a food chain.

Plants are called producers because they produce food—they are at the start of the food chain.

Herbivores are called primary consumers because they are the first link in the food chain.



Carnivores are called secondary consumers because they are the second link in the food chain.

